

Rafael Bello Lara

Backend Engineer · Java · Spring Boot · Microservices

I design and ship production-grade backend systems — microservices, REST APIs, and event-driven platforms — for banking, financial services, and e-commerce. 15+ years across teams in Cuba, Venezuela, the United States, and Germany, now based in Sofia.



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15+ YEARS IN JAVA	4 COUNTRIES WORKED IN	MSc APPLIED INFORMATICS	SFPC SCRUM CERTIFIED
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PROFILE

About

Senior Software Engineer with 15+ years of experience in backend development using Java, the Spring Framework, and Spring Boot. Proven track record designing and delivering scalable, production-grade microservices and RESTful APIs for international clients in the banking, financial services, and e-commerce industries.

I drive solution design from requirements through deployment, mentor junior and mid-level engineers, and work comfortably with client-facing responsibilities across multicultural teams. Strong hands-on expertise with J2EE, Hibernate, relational databases, Kafka, CI/CD pipelines, Docker, and AWS. Scrum Foundation certified, currently based in Sofia with travel and relocation flexibility.

Domains: **Banking** · **Fintech** · **E-commerce** Focus: **Microservices** · **REST** · **Kafka**
Status: **Open to opportunities**

CAREER

Experience

- Senior Software Engineer Raisin GmbH**
Sep 2021 – Present · 4+ years · Sofia, Bulgaria
 - Designed and delivered **20+** production microservices and common libraries of varying complexity using Java, Spring Boot, JPA, and Hibernate within a distributed architecture.
 - Defined and documented **9+** REST APIs with OpenAPI/Swagger, ensuring consistency and contract-first development.
 - Implemented Apache Kafka consumers and producers powering event-driven communication across **~2M** events/day.
 - Designed and implemented an AWS Managed Airflow (MWAA) DAG automating data synchronization and monitoring across Amazon RDS for MySQL, Snowflake, and Looker.
 - Created and maintained microservice databases — schema design, migrations, and query optimization.
 - Authored unit (JUnit, Mockito), integration, and component tests following TDD, sustaining **85%+** code coverage.
 - Mentored **2** junior and mid-level engineers through code reviews, pairing, and coding standards.
- Stack** · Java · Spring Boot · Spring AOP · JPA · Hibernate · OpenAPI · Kafka · REST · GitLab CI/CD · Maven · AWS · Docker · Airflow (MWAA) · Snowflake · Looker

○ **Software Engineer** **BOSCH – ProCon**

Mar 2021 – Aug 2021 · 6 months · Sofia, Bulgaria

- Implemented **5+** new REST API endpoints and extended existing services for a microservice-based platform.
- Developed Kafka consumers and producers for asynchronous inter-service communication.
- Created and updated microservice database schemas to support evolving business requirements.
- Wrote unit, integration, and component tests, contributing to **85%+** code coverage.

Stack · Java · Spring Boot · JPA · Hibernate · REST · Kafka · Bitbucket · Maven · AWS · Docker

○ **Architect / Backend Developer** **Curu Inc.**

Jan 2018 – Mar 2021 · 3+ years · Charlotte, NC, USA (Remote)

- Designed and built a RESTful API (Java, Spring Boot, JAX-RS) helping **10k+** users manage personal credit through notifications and behavioral analytics.
- Integrated **2** third-party financial platforms (Even Financial, Yodlee) for personalized offers and data synchronization.
- Applied AI/ML techniques (K-Means clustering, association rules, multi-criteria decision making) for credit behavior analysis.
- Architected an intelligent notification system advising users on credit management based on financial activity.
- Developed serverless microservices on AWS (API Gateway, Lambda, DynamoDB) handling **1M+** requests/month, cutting infrastructure cost by **~30%** versus always-on services.
- Led solution design as principal architect, guiding a team of **4** developers.

Stack · Java · Spring Boot · JAX-RS · REST · SOAP · PostgreSQL · DynamoDB · AWS Lambda · API Gateway · Docker · CI/CD · Digital Ocean

○ **Senior Software Developer** **Conoce Cuba**

Sep 2015 – Dec 2017 · 2+ years · Havana, Cuba

- Developed the Conoce Cuba application for Windows — a geospatial tourism guide with map-based points of interest.
- Engineered data pipelines exporting and processing datasets to SQLite databases consumed by multiple client applications.
- Managed geospatial information systems for location services and map rendering.

Stack · C++ · Qt · SQLite · Git · UNIX/Linux

○ **Software Developer / Architect** **National Bank of Cuba – UCI**

Oct 2014 – Jul 2015 · Havana, Cuba

- Led the technology transfer of the Quarxo Banking System to the National Bank of Cuba, managing end-to-end delivery.
- Delivered Java technology training and business-process knowledge to banking operations teams.
- Updated the SWIFT messaging subsystem to comply with evolving international standards.
- Provided real-time production support for **4** core banking subsystems: Letters of Credit, Negotiations & Payments, SWIFT Messaging, Accounting Open/Close.

Stack · Java · Spring · JPA · Hibernate · Jasper Reports · MS SQL Server · SVN

○ **Software Developer → Chief Architect** **Quarxo Banking System – UCI**

2011 – 2014 · 3 years · Havana, Cuba

- Developed the Letter of Credit subsystem and Transactions component for the national banking automation platform.
- Promoted to Chief Architect based on technical leadership and delivery quality.
- Led certification processes with external auditing firms (Segurmática, CONAS S.A.).

Stack · Java · Spring · JPA · Hibernate · Jasper Reports · MS SQL Server · SVN

○ **Software Developer** **Export & Commerce Bank C.A. (SABIC)**

2010 – 2011 · Caracas, Venezuela

- Adapted the SABIC banking automation system to Venezuelan regulatory and financial standards.
- Implemented the Trust Process module and integrated accounting with automated check issuance and printing.
- Optimized daily Accounting Start and Close processes for improved system performance.

Stack · Visual FoxPro · MS SQL Server

TOOLBOX

Technical skills

LANGUAGES

Java (15+ yrs)

J2EE

SQL

Python

C++

PHP

JavaScript

XML

FRAMEWORKS

Spring Boot

Spring Framework

Spring AOP

Spring Batch

Hibernate

JPA

JAX-RS

Django

ASP.NET MVC

LangChain4j

WEB & PROTOCOLS

REST

SOAP

JSON

XML

HTTP

OpenAPI / Swagger

DATABASES

PostgreSQL

MySQL

MS SQL Server

Oracle

SQLite

Neo4j

DynamoDB

MESSAGING

Apache Kafka

RabbitMQ

Producers & consumers

Event-driven

CLOUD & DEVOPS

AWS (API Gateway, Lambda, DynamoDB, EC2)

Docker

Digital Ocean

Jenkins

GitLab CI

Maven

Gradle

TESTING

JUnit

Mockito

Integration testing

Component testing

TDD

PRACTICES & TOOLS

Microservices architecture

Design patterns

REST API design

Agile / Scrum

Code review

Technical mentoring

Git

Jira / Confluence

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ACADEMICS

Education

MSc – Applied Informatics University of Informatics Sciences, Havana · 2012 – 2014	Computer Science Engineer – Honours University of Informatics Sciences, Havana · 2005 – 2010
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PUBLICATIONS

Research

Published researcher in Artificial Intelligence and Applied Computing, with results in internationally recognized scientific journals.

- 01
- Compensatory Fuzzy Logic for Intelligent Social Network Analysis
- 02
- Model for Static Analysis in Fuzzy Graphs Based on Composite Centrality Indicators
- 03
- Static Analysis of Scientific Collaboration Networks
- Cuban Journal of Computer Science
- 04
- Technique for Static Network Analysis Based on Fuzzy Logic and Aggregation Operators

Spanish
Native

English
Professional working proficiency